

Presentation Questions

Below are potential questions judges may ask during your Invention presentation. You are not expected to memorize answers to every question. Instead, use these questions to practice explaining your invention clearly and confidently.

The best way to prepare is to think of your presentation as telling a story — the story of your invention. If you can explain your process from start to finish, many of these answers will come naturally!

Think of Your Story Like This:

1. **The Problem** – What did you notice or experience that needed a solution?
2. **The Research** – What did you learn? What already exists?
3. **The Idea** – How did you imagine your solution? What other ideas did you come up with?
4. **The Design & Build** – How did you create it and what materials did you use/why?
5. **Testing & Improving** – What worked? What didn't?
6. **The Impact** – Why does your invention matter?

Possible Judge Questions to Practice

1. How did you identify your problem?
2. What were some alternate solutions you considered?
3. How does your invention solve the problem or meet a specific need?
4. What did you learn while researching your idea?
5. How widespread is the problem you are trying to solve?
6. Is there a similar invention that already exists?
7. Based on your research, why is your invention better or different?
8. Why should someone buy or use your invention?
9. What makes your invention unique and useful?
10. How does your invention work?
11. What materials did you use and why?
12. What are the pros and cons of the materials you chose?
13. Did you test your invention? How?
14. Was your invention difficult to make? What challenges did you face?
15. Did anyone help you, and what parts did you do on your own?
16. If you had more time, what changes or improvements would you make?

Helpful Tips for Students

- Judges are **not trying to trick you** — they want to understand your thinking.
- It's okay to say **"I learned this didn't work at first"** — that shows growth.
- Speak clearly, make eye contact, and be proud of your work.
- Remember: **every invention starts as an idea** — what matters most is your process.

If you can explain **how you got from your first idea to your final invention**, you are already well prepared. Judges are there to help support you, especially our young inventors. They want you to be successful!